Example:
Telecom Regulatory Authority of India – **TRAI.**
Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India – **IRDAI.**

The Eight Basic Consumer Rights

1. The Right to Basic Needs.
2. The Right to Safety.
3. The Right to Information.
4. The Right to Choose.
5. The Right to Representation.
6. The Right to Redress.
7. The Right to Consumer Education.
8. The Right to a Healthy Environment.

The Consumer Protection Act, 1986 (COPRA)

This Act enacted in 1986 in the Parliament of India to protect the interests of consumers. It makes for the establishment of consumer councils and other authorities for the settlement of consumer's grievances and for matters connected there with it. The act was passed in Assembly in October 1986 and came into force on December 24, 1986.

COPRA is regarded as the 'Magna Carta' in the field of consumer protection for checking unfair trade practices, 'defects in goods' and 'deficiencies in services' as far as India is concerned. It has led to the establishment of a widespread network of consumer forums and appellate courts all over India. It has significantly impacted how businesses approach consumer complaints and has empowered consumers to a great extent.

Consumer Protection Councils are established at the national, state and district level to increase consumer awareness. To increase the awareness of consumers, there are many consumer organisations and NGOs that have been established.

Consumer Disputes Redressal Agencies

National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission (NCDRC): Established by the Central Government. It deals with matters of more than 10 million.

State Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission (SCDRC): Also known as the "State Commission" established by the State Government in the State. It is a state level court that takes up cases valuing less than ₹10 million.

District Consumer Disputes Redressal Forum (DCDRF): Also known as the "District Forum" established by the State Government in each district of the State. The State Governments may establish more than one District Forum in a district. It is a district level court that deals with cases valuing up to ₹2 million.

Consumer protection Act of 2019

Indian Parliament, in August 2019, passed the landmark Consumer Protection Bill, 2019 which aims to provide the timely and effective administration and settlement of consumer disputes in this Digital Age. The New Act will come into force on such date as the Central Government may so notify. The New Act seeks to replace more than 3 (three) decades old Consumer Protection Act, 1986 (Act).

Highlights of the New Act:

1. **E-Commerce Transactions:** The New Act has widened the definition of 'consumer'. The definition now includes any person who buys any goods, whether through offline or online transactions, electronic means, teleshopping, direct selling or multi-level marketing.

7th Std - Social Science Term III Civics Uni 2 EM.indd 194 11-11-2019 11.53.40 AM